

Kropatschek rifle

A **Kropatschek** is any variant of a rifle designed by Alfred von Kropatschek. Kropatschek's rifles used a tubular magazine (constructed of nickel-plated steel) of his design, of the same type used in the Japanese Murata Type 22 and the German Mauser Gewehr 1871/84. While designed for black powder, the Kropatschek action proved to be strong enough to handle smokeless powder.

The Kropatschek was the basis for the French Lebel M1886.^[10]

Variants

Austria-Hungary:

- ***Gendarmerie Repetier-Karabiner M1881***: 11 mm Gendarmerie Carbine (also known as **M1874/81**);
- ***Kropatschek Torpedo Boats Gewehr M1893***: 8 mm Navy Rifle for Torpedo boat crews.

France:

- ***Fusil de Marine Mle 1878***: 11 mm Navy Rifle;
- ***Fusil d'Infanterie Mle 1884***: 11 mm Infantry Rifle;
- ***Fusil d'Infanterie Mle 1885***: 11 mm Infantry Rifle.

Portugal:

- ***Espingarda de Infantaria 8 mm m/1886***: 8 mm Infantry Rifle;
- ***Carabina de Caçadores 8 mm m/1886***: 8 mm Light Infantry Carbine;
- ***Carabina de Cavalaria 8 mm m/1886***: 8 mm Cavalry Carbine;
- ***Carabina da Guarda Fiscal 8 mm m/1886/88***: 8 mm Treasury Guard Carbine;
- ***Espingarda de Infantaria 8 mm m/1886/89***: 8 mm Colonial Infantry Rifle;

Kropatschek/Steyr-Kropatschek



Portuguese Kropatschek (Second from top)

Type	Rifle
Place of origin	<u>Austria-Hungary</u>
Service history	
In service	1886 – Present
Used by	<u>Austria-Hungary</u> <u>France</u> <u>Chile</u> <u>Brazil</u> ^[1] <u>Kingdom of Portugal</u> <u>Ethiopian Empire</u> <u>Russian Empire</u> ^[2] <u>Spanish Republic</u> ^[3]
Wars	<u>War of the Pacific</u> ^[4] <u>Revolta da Armada</u> <u>Federalist Revolution</u> ^[5] <u>First Italo-Ethiopian War</u> ^[6]

- ***Carabina de Artilharia 8 mm m/1886/91***: 8 mm Artillery Carbine.

See also

- Antique firearms

References

1. "ArmasBrasil - Carabina Kropatschek" (<http://www.armasbrasil.com/SecXIX/declinio/ArmasFogo/kropatschek.htm>).

2. "Scraping the bottom of the barrel blackpowder rifles of the great war part 1" (<https://www.thefreelibrary.com/Scraping+the+bottom+of+the+barrel+blackpowder+rifles+of+the+great+war...-a0344213051>).

3. "Foreign Rifles of the Spanish Republic, 1936-1939" (<https://surplused.com/index.php/2020/06/15/foreign-rifles-of-the-spanish-republic-1936-1939/>).

4. Esposito, Gabriele, *Armies of the War of the Pacific 1879-83*: Osprey Publishing (2016)

5. "O EXÉRCITO REPUBLICANO" (<https://www.acadhistoria.com.br/livros/ExRepublicano.pdf>) (PDF).

6. McLachlan, Sean (20 Sep 2011). *Armies of the Adowa Campaign 1896: The Italian Disaster in Ethiopia*. Men-at-Arms 471. Osprey Publishing. pp. 35–36. ISBN 9781849084574.

7. VILLELA Jr, M E C. CANUDOS: memórias de um combatente. 2 ed. Rio de Janeiro: EdUERJ, 1997. p. 107.

8. 8x56 R Kropatschek Short - MUNICION.org (spanish) (<http://www.municion.org/8x56R/8x56R.htm>)

9. 8x60 R Guedes - Kropatschek - MUNICION.org (spanish) (<http://www.municion.org/8x60RGuedes/Guedes.htm>)

10. "French Rifle Ammunition: 8mm Lebel and 7.5mm French" (<http://www.forgottenweapons.com/french-rifle-ammunition-8mm-lebel-and-7-5mm-french/>). 7 August 2017.

External links

- French 1878 Marine Kropatschek (<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FSH7ImdrOEw>) Forgotten Weapons

War of Canudos^[7]
Second Boer War
World War I
Spanish Civil War
World War II (Portuguese colonies)
Annexation of Goa
Portuguese Colonial War

Production history	
Designer	<u>Alfred von Kropatschek</u>
Designed	1886
Produced	1886–circa 1898
Variants	Long rifle, short rifle
Specifications	
Mass	4.3 kg (9.5 lb)
Length	1320 mm (4 ft)
<u>Barrel length</u>	820 mm (32.3 in)
<u>Cartridge</u>	<u>11×59mmR Gras</u> <u>8×56mmR Kropatschek Corto</u> ^[8] <u>8×60mmR Guedes</u> ^[9]
<u>Caliber</u>	8mm (.329 in)
<u>Action</u>	<u>Bolt action</u>
<u>Muzzle velocity</u>	609 m/s (2,000 ft/s)

Effective firing range	2406 yd (2,200 m)
Feed system	8-round integral tubular magazine

Retrieved from "https://en.wikipedia.org/w/index.php?title=Kropatschek_rifle&oldid=1185363394"

■